

Full rules / 1. Souls and setup

Premise, ending and cycles

One player is Charon's apprentice. Choose one of two offered destinations each outward round. Deliveries are optional and only to preferred destinations. A cycle begins with boarding and ends after the empty boat returns. There is no cycle cap, delivery target or automatic win. At zero Light, stop immediately. A voluntary workshop stop is a session stop, not a victory.

Starting state

Light 6, maximum 6; ordinary capacity 4 seats; no memories; cycle 1; global outward round 0; all anger 0. Initial shore: Mother, Child, Merchant, Mason, Cook. Initial shuffled arrival pile: Soldier, Poet, Keeper.

Soul roster

Soul	Seats	Destination	Fixed reward
Mother	1	Tartarus	Light
Child	1	Haven	None
Merchant	1	River Styx	Foresight
Soldier	2	River Styx	Guard
Poet	1	Elysium	Foresight
Cook	1	Asphodel	Calm
Mason	1	Acheron	Fog Shield
Keeper	1	Asphodel	Fog Shield
PoLong	0	Tartarus	None

Boarding

Board at least one ordinary soul within 4 seats. Soldier occupies 2 seats; place the second-seat marker beside it. Reverse choices freely before departure. Boarding resets Ship Anger to 0, whatever the old Shore Anger. After departure, do not unload back onto the shore. No older-version passive powers apply.

One active ordinary card per identity. PoLong is a separate zero-seat type whose scheduled arrivals are independent instances. Its spare cards are supplies, not extra scheduled spawns.

Full rules / 2. Outward sequence

1 Optional memory

Play at most one memory before the outward round. Consume it from your hand, resolve its effect and any rewards or excess-hand choice. If Passage empties the boat, return immediately; do not advance the global round or spawn.

2 Advance and spawn

Advance the global outward counter. On rounds 3, 6, 9 and every later multiple of 3, add a PoLong at Ship Anger 0. It takes 0 seats. Boarding, returning and Passage do not advance this counter.

3 Choose and pay

Choose one of the two offers. Base fog + current PoLong contributions - a played Fog Shield = payable fog, minimum 0. Each PoLong at anger 0-1 adds 0; at anger 2-3 adds 1. Apply Guard prevention after calculating fog. Pay Light. At 0, lose immediately, before delivery.

4 Optional delivery

Deliver any subset of passengers whose preferred destination matches. Keep the rest aboard. Each eligible ordinary delivery grants its fixed fresh memory, even after that soul recycles. Child and PoLong grant none. Resolve family quest rewards as applicable. Delivery and Haven do not heal Light.

5 Anger and wraiths

Every passenger still aboard gains 1 Ship Anger, including a newly spawned PoLong. Each reaching 4 becomes a wraith: apply 1 Light loss, then remove it. Guard prevents only the next 1 point. Stop immediately at 0. Wraiths do not remain to add fog. Ordinary cards enter the resolved discard; removed PoLong becomes reusable supply.

6 Continue or return

After rewards, choose which excess memories to discard until the hand contains at most 3. If the boat is empty, return. Otherwise another outward round is available. Newly earned memories are usable only before a later round or return; they cannot rescue zero Light.

Full rules / 3. Memories

How to play a memory

At most one before each outward round or return. It is single-use: return the used card to its source-labeled reserve. Unused cards persist across cycles. After receiving rewards, choose excess cards to discard to reserve until holding at most 3. Never take a held copy to pay a new reward.



Light

Restore 1 Light, maximum 6.



Foresight

Reveal both options at the current fork and next two forks. Revealed options stay visible for this cycle.



Guard

Prevent the next 1 point of Light loss during this outward round or return, including fog or wraith damage. Unused protection expires at that round/return's end.



Calm

Reduce one active soul's current Shore or Ship Anger by 1, minimum 0. It may target PoLong. It cannot revive a removed soul.



Fog Shield

Reduce total fog for this crossing by 1, minimum 0. It does not prevent wraith damage.



Passage

Instantly deliver one onboard soul to its preferred destination with the ordinary reward for that soul, no fog, no anger advance and no outward-round advance. It may target PoLong. If it empties the boat, this use also occupies the immediate return's memory allowance.

Fixed rewards, renewable supply

Merchant and Poet each give their own source-labeled Foresight. Mason and Keeper each give their own Fog Shield. Four copies per rewarding source support a 3-card held hand plus the next reward. Memory supply is not random. Passage follows the same hand limit and one-memory limit.

Full rules / 4. Return and quest

Return only when the boat is empty

Return has no travel fog and does not advance the outward counter. If the memory allowance is available, optionally play one before resolving return. Passage that just emptied the boat already used this allowance.

1 Waiting anger first

Every ordinary soul already waiting gains 1 Shore Anger. At 2, it becomes a wraith: lose 1 Light subject to Guard, then place it in the resolved discard. Stop immediately on zero Light, before recovery.

2 Recovery and cycle

If still alive, restore 2 Light, capped at 6. Record one completed cycle. The next cycle is completed cycles + 1; there is no limit or scheduled final return.

3 Refill and prepare

Refill the shore to 5. Draw from the arrival pile. Whenever it runs out during refill, shuffle only resolved ordinary souls into a new arrival pile. New arrivals start at anger 0 and do not receive this return's increment. The facilitator supplies the next cycle's offers.

Family quest: once per run

Deliver Child to Haven before delivering Mother to Tartarus. These deliveries may occur in different cycles. On that qualifying Mother delivery, take her usual Light memory and one Passage. The quest is optional. Keep its state across cycles and soul recycling.

AVAILABLE: Neither required delivery has yet qualified.

CHILD DELIVERED: Child has qualified; Mother is still required.

COMPLETED: Mother qualified after Child. Passage was awarded. Never award it again this run.

FAILED: Mother was delivered before Child qualified, or a still-required family member was lost before its required delivery. Recycling gives no retry.

A later recycled Child's fate does not undo the recorded qualifying Child delivery. Completed or failed quest state never resets during the run.

Full rules / 5. Worked examples

Outward round 6, from the shared rules

Light 4; Keeper and Soldier at Ship Anger 3. Play Fog Shield, then spawn PoLong at 0. Choose Asphodel: $2 - 1 = 1$ fog, so Light becomes 3. Deliver Keeper for a fresh Fog Shield. Soldier reaches 4 anger, costs 1 Light and enters the resolved discard. Light is now 2. PoLong reaches 1 anger; the boat is not empty.

Full boat and a new PoLong

Four ordinary seats are occupied before global round 3. Resolve the optional memory, then add PoLong without ejecting anybody. On Haven with no older PoLong penalty, its anger 0 adds no fog. If retained, it becomes anger 1 after delivery.

Calm and stacked fog

Two PoLong instances are at anger 2 and 3. Calm lowers the first to 1. Their contributions are now $0 + 1$. Haven's base 0 therefore costs 1 Light. Both remaining instances then gain anger; the second reaches 4 and costs another 1 Light before leaving.

Returning at low Light

Light 1 and one waiting soul at Shore Anger 1. Without protection, it reaches 2 and its wraith damage ends the run. The later 2-Light recovery never happens. With Guard, prevent that 1 loss, remove the soul, then recover to Light 3.

Renewable reward and overflow

Three Merchant Foresight cards remain in hand. Deliver Merchant again: take the fourth copy. Choose any one of the four to discard to Merchant's reserve. Held rewards are never confiscated to supply another reward.

Passage ends a cycle

Only Poet is aboard. Play Passage: deliver Poet for Foresight, without fog, anger or outward-counter change. Return immediately. Passage already used that return's memory allowance; the new Foresight cannot be played during the same return.

These are worked rule examples and agent desk checks, not records of human play.

Full rules / 6. Routes and recycling

Facilitator owns the route

Provide six distinct destination pictures, excluding the shore. The facilitator chooses, orders, shuffles and hands out offers. There is no prescribed repeating map, guaranteed destination or forced starting order. Each outward round still offers two destinations.

Stage three forks with six reusable slips

Mark exactly one destination on each slip. Put two slips in CURRENT, two in NEXT and two in NEXT + 1. Current offers face up; future offers face down on opaque backs. Put the corresponding picture cards beside the current pair when useful. A slip identifies its destination and fog even when a picture is already used elsewhere. Duplicates in the facilitator's sequence need no extra rule.

Reveal and retain information

Foresight reveals both options in the current fork and the next two forks. Before spending it, make sure the facilitator has supplied all three pairs. If required offers are missing, pause without consuming the card or advancing time. Revealed offers remain visible for the cycle. Before erasing or reusing slips, copy already revealed offers to a visible pencil ledger; add paper as needed.

Advance the physical queue

After a crossing, slide NEXT to CURRENT and NEXT + 1 to NEXT. The facilitator refills the last pair according to their chosen ordering. Reveal the new current pair normally. Do not expose an unrevealed future pair while moving it. A missing next offer is a pause for input, not a penalty or game ending.

Recycle souls and memories separately

Ordinary souls delivered or expired go to the resolved-soul discard. Shuffle that discard only when the arrival pile runs out while refilling. Never include souls aboard or waiting. If both piles are temporarily empty, do not create duplicates. Used and discarded memories return immediately to their own source reserve. PoLong stays outside ordinary piles; erase old anger before reuse.

Reset after a run

Record loss or voluntary stop on page 11. Sort all pieces, recover every held memory to reserve, clear PoLong and anger, set Light 6, round 0, completed cycles 0, deliveries 0 and quest AVAILABLE. Restore the five starting shore souls and shuffle the other three. The facilitator prepares new offers. Add paper when a counter or ledger fills; its edge is never a game cap.